The Git Change Lifecycle

From issue to protected trunk — a governed, evidence-driven change pipeline.

ISSUE-DRIVEN ◆ POLICY-GATED ◆ PROTECTED TRUNK

I INTAKE

A request becomes a contract.

- Issue-defined scope
- EARS requirements
- Owner-confirmed criteria
- No work without a contract

GATE · CRITERIA CONFIRMED

II ISOLATE

One change, one clean base.

- Ephemeral worktree
- One branch, one change
- Pinned to origin/master
- No shared working tree

GATE · CLEAN BASE

III BUILD

Small, traceable units.

- Atomic commits
- Traced to the issue
- Deliberate staging
- Small, reviewable diffs

GATE · COMMITS READY

IV VERIFY

Proof, per criterion.

- Unit · integration · e2e
- Lint · format · policy
- Fail-closed gates
- Evidence per criterion

GATE · ALL CHECKS GREEN

V GOVERN

Policy before trunk.

- Required CI checks
- Human sign-off, high-risk
- Protected trunk
- No admin bypass

GATE · APPROVED

VI RELEASE

Land, then reconcile.

- Merge commit, history kept
- Confirm & reconcile
- Prune, fast-forward
- Issue closed

GATE · MERGED

OUTCOMES

Protected trunk
No direct pushes to master

Full traceability
Issue → commit → PR → merge

Zero drift
Worktrees and branches pruned

Deterministic rollback
Per-change commit history

The Change Decision Tree

Every gate a change must clear — from intake to protected master.

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